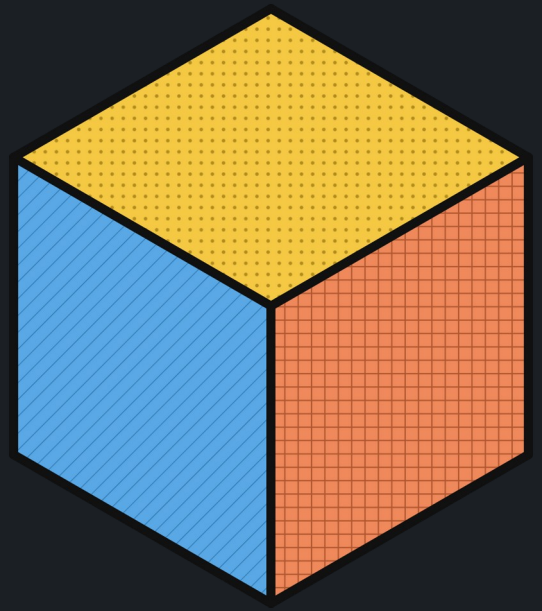
# Sketching Is a Language

Drawing Basics 1. Pictures that everyone in the shop reads the same way.



# Name this object

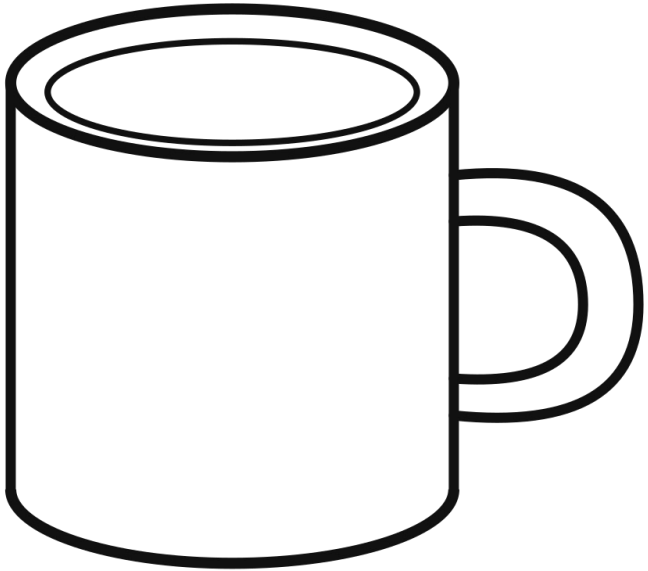
A cylindrical vessel of glazed ceramic, 85 mm in outside diameter and 100 mm tall, with a wall 6 mm thick and a flat, closed base. The top is open. A single C-shaped loop of elliptical section, 10 mm by 14 mm, is joined to the outer wall at two points, 25 mm and 75 mm below the rim, and projects 35 mm from the wall. It holds 350 millilitres.

# It's a coffee mug.

70 words, and you were still guessing.

## One sketch. Nobody asks.

Words are slow and everyone pictures something different. A sketch is one look, and we all see the same thing.

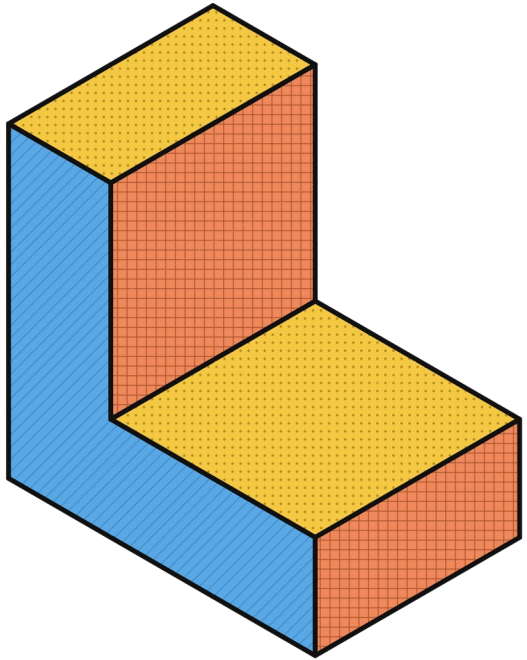


# Sketching is a language

1. **Words**
   Slow. Everyone pictures something different.

2. **A sketch**
   One look. Same picture for everyone in the shop.

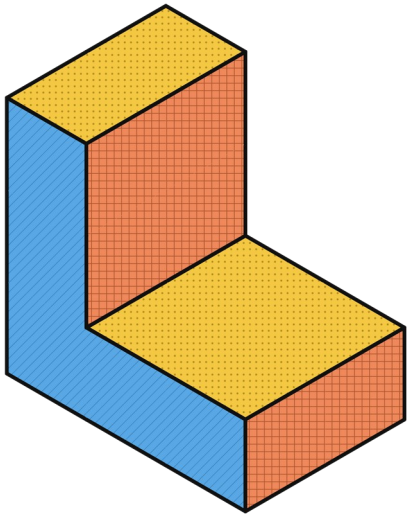
3. **Grammar**
   A language has rules: views, line types, grids. That is what we learn here.



# Two ways to say the same block

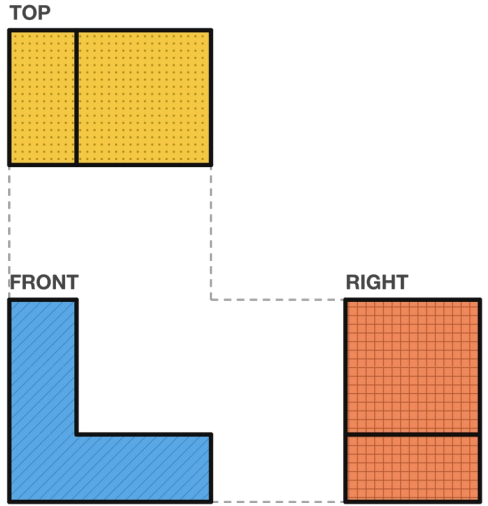
## ISOMETRIC

The picture. Three faces at once. Drawn on the triangle grid.

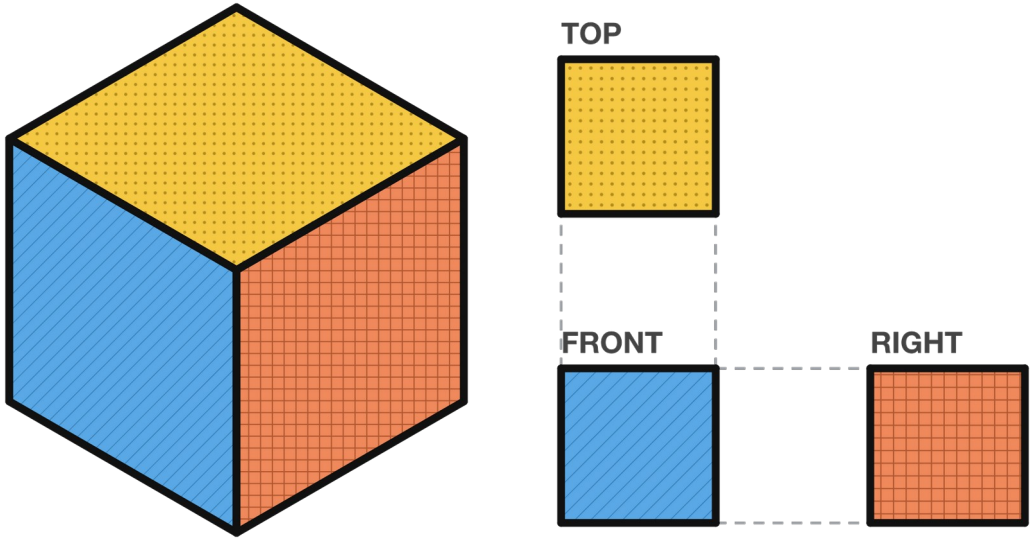


## ORTHOGRAPHIC

One face at a time, straight on. Drawn on the square grid.



# Orthographic means one face at a time




Look straight at one face. You see a flat shape with no depth.

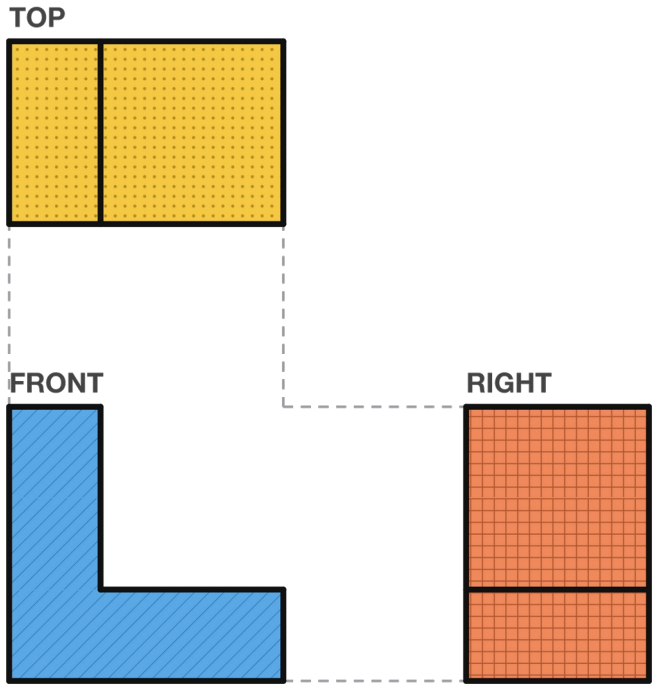
Top, front, right: three looks, three flat shapes. The colour tells you which face you are looking at.

**TOP**

**FRONT**

**RIGHT**

# The three views line up



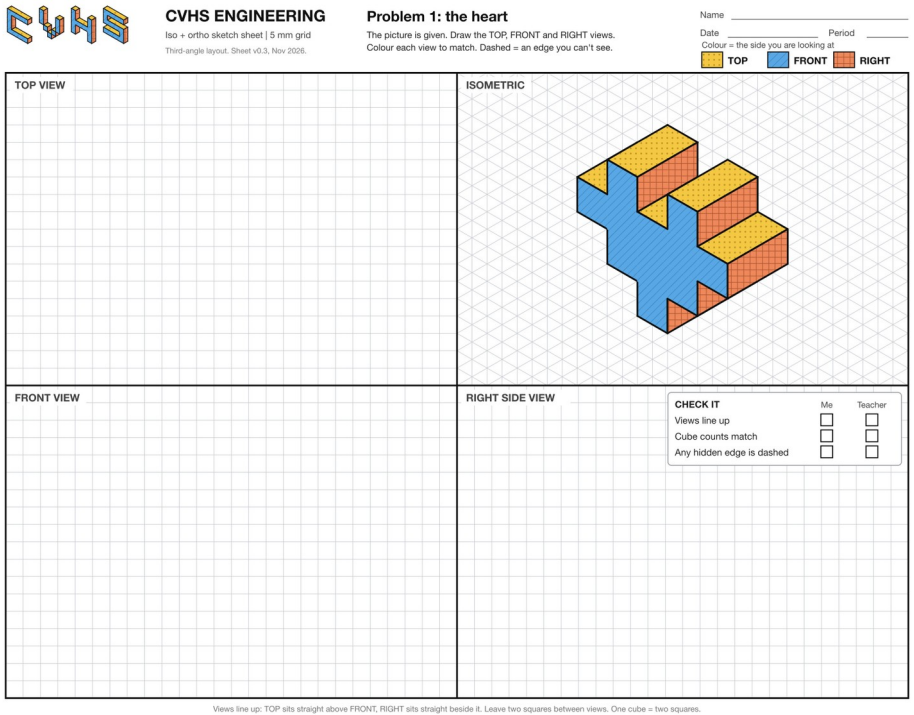

**TOP sits straight above FRONT.** They share width.

**RIGHT sits straight beside FRONT.** They share height.

**TOP and RIGHT** share depth.

**Count cubes.** Do not guess.

# Your sheet



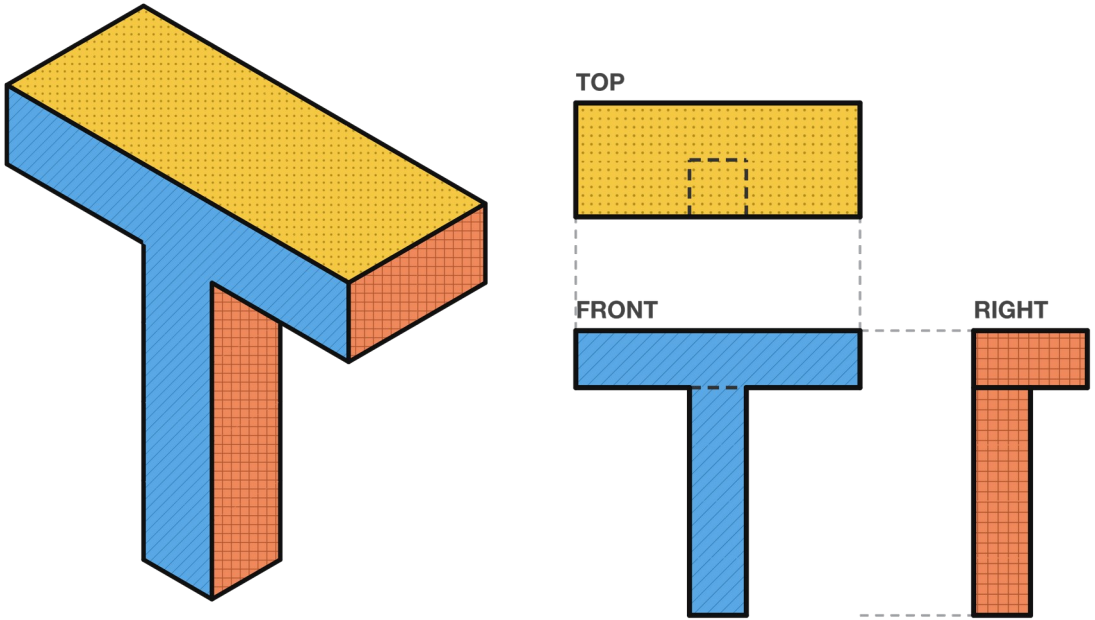

**Square grid, three views.** TOP above FRONT, RIGHT beside it.

**Triangle grid, top right.** The isometric picture goes here.

**One cube = two squares.** Two triangle edges on the iso grid. Same size everywhere, so nothing needs measuring.

**Check it box.** Tick yours before you hand it in.

# Dashed means hidden




The stem is tucked under the bar. From the top you cannot see it, but it is still there.

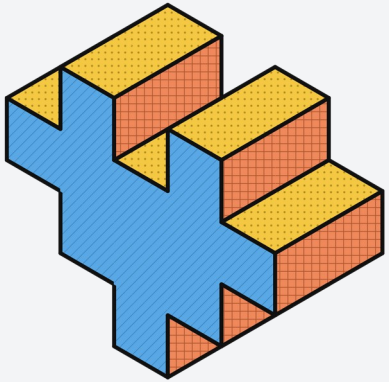
**An edge you cannot see is drawn dashed.**

Solid line: an edge you can see. Dashed line: an edge behind a face.

# Both directions, today

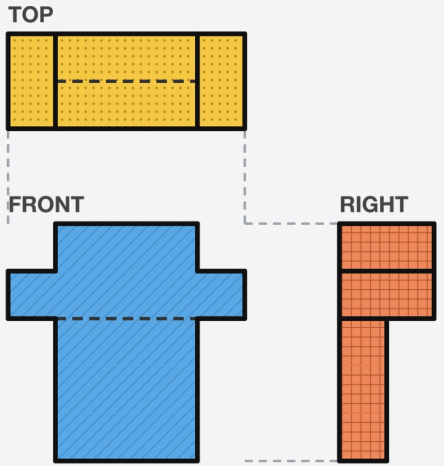
**Picture given. Draw the three views.**

Problems 1 to 4: heart, 6, 7, ghost



**Views given. Draw the picture.**

Problems 5 to 7: mushroom, trophy, cactus



# How to sketch on the grid

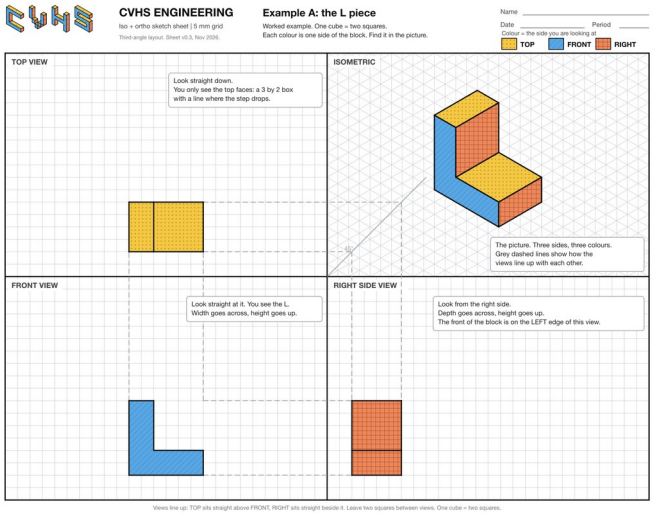
1. **Pencil, light lines first.**
   You will fix things. Make that cheap.

2. **Count cubes from what is given.**
   Two squares each. Width, height, depth.

3. **Darken the lines you are sure of.**
   Corners sharp, lines on the grid.

4. **Dashed for anything hidden.**
   A face in front of an edge: dash the edge.

5. **Line the views up before you call it done.**
   TOP over FRONT, RIGHT beside it.



# Say it with a sketch

Grab a sheet. Start with Example A.

